

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

CHA lawyers cite nonexistent case

Firm used ChatGPT in motion to persuade judge to reconsider jury's verdict against the agency

By **Lizzie Kane**
Chicago Tribune

Lawyers hired by the Chicago Housing Authority recently cited Illinois Supreme Court case *Mack v. Anderson* in an effort to persuade a judge to reconsider a jury's \$24 million verdict against the agency in a case involving the alleged poisoning of two children by lead paint in CHA-owned property.

The problem?

The case doesn't exist.

In the latest headache for CHA, law firm Goldberg Segalla used artificial intelligence, specifically ChatGPT, in a post-trial motion and neglected to check its work, court records show. A jury decided in January, after a roughly seven-week trial, that CHA must pay more than \$24 million to two residents who sued on behalf of

their children, finding the agency responsible for the children's injuries, including past and future damages.

The firm apologized for the error in a June 18 court filing, calling it a "serious lapse in professionalism."

"An exhaustive investigation revealed that one attorney, in direct violation of Goldberg Segalla's AI use policy, used AI technology and failed to verify the AI citation before including the case and surrounding sentence describing its fictitious holding," said Gold-

berg Segalla's lead counsel in the case, Larry Mason, in the filing.

Mason, whom the judge admonished for shouting during closing arguments in January, noted that "several contributors" supported him while preparing the motion. He also said in the filing that the investigation found "no intent to deceive the Court" and no other attorneys at the firm were aware of the improper citation.

Goldberg Segalla has since implemented "firm-wide measures to re-educate its attorneys" on its AI use policy, the filing

said, and "established preventative measures." The firm requested that the court not punish CHA for the attorney's mistake.

In response to a list of Tribune questions, CHA provided a copy of a letter that its interim Chief Legal Officer Elizabeth Silas sent Wednesday to Mason and said Goldberg Segalla has taken "all responsibility" in this matter.

In the letter, Silas thanked Mason for bringing the AI issue to the agency's attention and for apol-

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Chicago arts groups press on despite federal cuts

White House calls for sweeping reductions, elimination of NEA

By **Tess Kenny**
Chicago Tribune

To Nita Win, a South Shore mom of two, there's a freedom of expression that the arts provide that's refreshing. It's a feeling, that as much as she can, Win tries to expose to her 8-year-old daughter and 14-year-old son.

On Tuesday night, Win and her family did just that, attending the opening performance of this year's Rhythm World, the country's longest-running tap dance festival that for 35 years now has called Chicago home.

She left the performance, a free showcase at downtown's Studebaker Theater, amazed. She enjoyed every bit, though she thought it bittersweet, knowing she could have seen more.

Amid federal funding cuts, this year's Rhythm World is nearly half as long as originally planned, spanning six days instead of 10.

"What a shame," Win said following Tuesday's performance, noting it was her family's first time at the festival. "Me being able to come here and experience this free performance is wonderful. And without ... funding, this is not possible."

Organizers opted to shorten the 35th anniversary programming so they could weather changes without losing the heart of the festival, they say. But their choice is becoming a familiar one these days, as federal downsizing places pressure on arts organizations across the Chicago area to make do without funding.

On May 2, the White House released President Donald Trump's budget proposal, which called for billions of dollars of sweeping cuts, including the elimination of the National Endowment for the Arts, the largest funder of arts and arts education in the country.

Candace Jackson looks forward to Rhythm World, which has long received NEA grant funding each year, the Edgewater resident said ahead of Tuesday's opening perfor-

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INSIDE

Burning questions for the second half



The Cubs entered the All-Star break with one of the best records in baseball. Can the offense keep producing? For the White Sox, one big question will be: Who will be dealt by the trade deadline? **Chicago Sports**

Sen. Wyden: Follow Epstein's money

The top Democrat on the Senate Finance Committee calls for the release of flagged bank transactions. **Nation & World**



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Making 'Good Trouble' in Loop

People attend a "Good Trouble" rally to protest President Donald Trump and his administration's rollback of civil rights at Daley Plaza in Chicago on Thursday. "Good Trouble Lives On" rallies were planned across the United States. **Chicagoland, Page 5**



Vanessa Mendoza stands Thursday at the intersection where her aunt, Rocío, was recently pulled over by unidentified agents questioning her citizenship while driving near West 24th Street and South 59th Court in Cicero. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

'WE'RE TIRED OF THIS'

Cicero residents demand action after Latina stopped by federal agents

By **Nell Salzman**
Chicago Tribune

Vanessa Mendoza, an early childhood educator in Cicero, was gathering materials for her classroom in late June when she paused to look at Facebook. What she saw shocked her.

Posted on the social media site was a video of her aunt, Rocío, being pulled over by unidentified agents driving black vehicles who questioned her citizenship — despite her legal status to be in the United States.

The agents did not specify why they pulled Rocío over or which agency they were affiliated with, Mendoza, 32, who grew up in Cicero, said at a news conference outside the town hall Thursday morning. After Rocío showed identification, she was not arrested or detained, her niece added.

"It was either a legal stop or maybe, I don't want to say, they were targeting her for being Latina," she said.

On Thursday, local officials and community members condemned 20-year Town

President Larry Dominick for remarks he previously made about the immigrant community, especially as federal enforcement actions intensify under President Donald Trump. About 90% of Cicero's residents are Latino, a group that has been repeatedly targeted by the Trump administration.

Rocío's interaction with the unidentified agents comes at a time of increased news and social media reports of citi-

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ICE to be given access to Medicaid information

Pact cites ability to track immigrants in country illegally

By **Kimberly Kindy** and **Amanda Seitz**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Immigration and Customs Enforcement officials will be given access to the personal data of the nation's 79 million Medicaid enrollees, including home addresses and ethnicities, to track down immigrants who may not be living legally in the United States, according to an agreement obtained by The Associated Press.

The information will give ICE officials the ability to find "the location of aliens" across the country, says the agreement signed Monday between the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services and the Department of Homeland Security.

The agreement has not been announced publicly.

The extraordinary disclosure of millions of such personal health data to deportation officials is the latest escalation in the Trump administration's immigration crackdown, which has repeatedly tested legal boundaries in its effort to arrest 3,000 people daily.

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